

"Well, he mentioned no name. But he prayed for the Lord's blessing on those who are about to demand their just due. Well . . . I tiptoed out. And that is the end of that case so far as I am concerned. I'd rather go to the poorhouse myself than evict that old couple." He seized the other man's arm. "Look! I'll pay their back rent myself, right now if you'll let them stay in that house."

"No," the property owner said. He rose and walked to a window. After a moment he too dabbed at his eyes. "I'll let them stay there as long as they wish." He turned and said ruefully, "I wish you hadn't listened to that petition not intended for your ears or mine."

The lawyer shook his head. "No, it was intended that I hear it and tell it to you. My old mother used to sing about God's moving in a mysterious way. . . ."

"I've heard that too," the property owner said. He twisted the claim papers in his hands, then tore them up. "Well, why don't you go over there in the morning and—uh—take this ten-dollar bill and bring them a basket of groceries."

"I'll match that ten and bring them a bigger basket."

"And—uh—just tell them the rent has been paid, will you?"

"Yes. Paid in a mysterious way." The two men smiled at each other.

This real estate owner dates his wealth from the day he broke the pattern of his life—the day he stopped grasping and started giving—the day when he felt the first stirrings of what came to be wonderful peace of mind.

Do not limit what you give, limit what you take. Of course, practically speaking, there is a limit to what one can give of his time and his resources. I have mentioned that your first duty is to help yourself, then help other people, and when this rule is applied correctly it still works wonders.

So when I say: *Do not limit what you give*, I mean there should be no limit on the *spirit* of your giving. The property owner, for example, had given charity before. But it was charity given as charity, to local causes which gratefully acknowledged his name—so it was good publicity for him and for his business.

One day he gave when the last thing he had counted on was giving—and that made the difference. One day he felt that something bigger than himself was working through his